2014 to 2019 before he took over as BJP national president. His first stint saw him launch Mission Indradhanush, which aimed at full child immunisation against various diseases. Under him a concerted fight was launched against TB

J.P. GANPATRAO, 63 | SHIV SENA

Four-time MP from Buldhana Maharashtra, MoS (IC) of Ayush ministry

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

MANAGING ANTIBIOTICS
Over a million people die each year globally due to infections from drug-resistant bacteria. India is one of the worst-hit nations, with nearly 60,000 newborns alone dying each year. Communication on antibiotic misuse is critical

FIGHTING TB
India has one of the highest burdens of tuberculosis in the world. Even though the TB mortality rate has gone down from 494,000 in 2021 to 331,000 in 2022, we are still nowhere close to eliminating the disease. Additionally, we are also dealing with the threat of drug-resistant TB

EXPANDING AFFORDABLE HEALTHCARE
While Ayushman Bharat has helped make healthcare accessible, the out-of-pocket expenditure in India remains inordinately high. Costs can be lowered by greater government investment

ENVIRONMENTAL THREATS
Air pollution, heatwaves and flood-borne pathogens are health threats. The government must have plans to handle these risks

RURAL OUTREACH
Health and wellness centres set up to deliver primary healthcare under Ayushman Bharat, and improving access to hospitalisation at the secondary/ tertiary levels under Jan Arogya Yojana must be implemented well, especially in rural India

CHEMICALS & FERTILISERS

Fertile Ground to Grow

Be it chemicals, fertilisers or raw material for pharmaceuticals, India must reduce its huge reliance on imports

BY HIMANSHU SHEKHAR

The Union ministry of chemicals and fertilisers is instrumental in ensuring India's food and drugs security. Other than chemicals and fertilisers, it also has a pharmaceutical department. India's chemical industry is highly diversified and covers over 80,000 commercial products. In the past few years, the country has emerged as a key player in bulk chemicals, speciality chemicals, agrochemicals, petrochemicals, polymers and fertilisers. In terms of volume, India is the world's second largest consumer of fertiliser, using around 3.5 MT of urea, out of which around 10 MT is imported. Reducing this dependence on fertiliser imports will likely remain a key priority of this government. The ministry has already begun work on starting new urea plants; as well as towards promoting nano-urea. With India considered the 'pharmacy capital of the world', the pharmaceutical department has worked towards moving from volume-based growth to value-based growth in the global pharma market in recent years. The government is also working to cut down imports of active pharmaceutical ingredients. To encourage domestic production, the production linked incentive (PLI) scheme is a great enabler. ■

J.P. NADDA
Minister of Chemicals & Fertilisers

Minister of State

ANUPRIYA PATEL, 43

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

Effective fertiliser supply/ management
Nadda has to ensure timely supply of fertilisers amid reports of shortage of DAP (Diammonium Phosphate) in the Kharif season. Another goal: reducing imports to zero

Promoting nano-fertilisers
After the success of nano-urea, the government launched nano-DAP and plans to introduce more nano fertilisers, which have nutrients coated within nano material

Reducing API import
India is dependent on China for Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (API) and Key Starting Materials (KSM)—raw materials for making medicines. New Indian firms must use PLI schemes for making these